

Current-State Journey Map

How institutional knowledge breaks down and rebuilds through people

— Persona A "The confused / lost student or faculty member"

Composite of Youssef, Mehdi, and Mohammed · AUI UX Bootcamp



The journey at a glance

- 1 Trigger**
An unfamiliar process appears
- 2 Initial search**
Tries official channels first
- 3 Hits a wall**
Official channel falls short
- 4 Turns to people**
Peer network activates
- 5 Resolution**
Gets the real answer
- 6 Becomes the source**
Now they're the one being asked

Emotional arc



DOING

Encounters a process for the first time — can hit at any point in an AUI career.
Youssef (week 1): class locations. Mehdi: Add/Drop. Mohammed (junior): exchange.

THINKING

"This must be documented somewhere."
"Where's Add/Drop on the portal?"
"Where is this class?"
"I need to go on exchange — now what?"

FEELING

Neutral to mildly uneasy. Not yet worried —
assumes the answer is one search away.

TOUCHPOINTS

Class schedule

Student portal

"Where's Add/Drop on the portal?"

Overheard conversations

PAIN POINT

The trigger is often time-sensitive (a class starting, a registration window, a document deadline); there's no slack to "figure it out".

DOING

Checks the obvious official source. Youssef goes to Admissions/Administration.
Mehdi digs through the student portal. Mohammed looks for a defined exchange process.

THINKING

"There has to be a clear procedure for this —
it's a big university."

FEELING

Still hopeful, slightly rushed.

TOUCHPOINTS

Admissions office (in person)

Student portal

Official website

"There has to be a clear procedure for this."

PAIN POINT

The information "technically exists" but isn't surfaced where they're looking

—
it's scattered across offices, platforms, and people's heads.

DOING

Gets an incomplete, inconsistent, or missing answer.
Youssef says AUI offices "often don't give a complete or accurate answer."

THINKING

"Even the office I went to didn't really know /
didn't tell me everything."

FEELING

Frustrated, sometimes a little embarrassed
for not already knowing.

TOUCHPOINTS

Admin office staff

Portal (no clear path)

"Even the office I went to didn't really know."

Assumed-but-unstated rules

PAIN POINT

Real cost: Mehdi's \$200/week storage fine, Youssef's curfew violation and DSA questioning

both because no one surfaced the rule in time

DOING

Falls back on informal channels — asks a Mentor, a friend, an upperclassman, or checks the Add/Drop Facebook group. Mohammed tracks down Sidra, someone who'd already done the exact exchange.

THINKING

"Someone who's already been through this will just tell me."

FEELING

Relief (there's a path forward) mixed with anxiety (dependent on one person responding).

TOUCHPOINTS

Mentor or friend

Add/Drop Facebook group

"Someone who's already been through this will just tell me."

WhatsApp/Instagram threads

PAIN POINT

No single trustworthy channel. The Facebook group "isn't 100% trustworthy" per Youssef. Success depends on knowing the right person

Specific known upperclassman

DOING

Receives the actual, practical answer — often a piece of tacit knowledge never written down.

THINKING

"Why didn't anyone just tell me this on day one?"

FEELING

Relief, sometimes tinged with frustration at how long it took.

TOUCHPOINTS

The trusted person (Mentor, upperclassman)

Tacit knowledge passed person-to-person

"Choose the professor, don't choose the time."

PAIN POINT

The answer lives in a single person, not in any searchable system. "Choose the professor, don't choose the time." — advice Youssef

Becomes the source

Now they're the one being asked

DOING

Having lived through it, they become a go-to answer source for the next student: exchange steps, undrop procedures, Add/Drop tricks.

THINKING

"I already answered this exact question for someone else last week."

FEELING

Mildly burdened but willing —
a sense of informal duty, not institutional responsibility.

TOUCHPOINTS

Word of mouth

Direct messages

"I already answered this exact question for someone else last week."

Being "that person" for a specific topic

PAIN POINT

The next cohort starts the loop over at Stage 1. This knowledge lives only in them. It isn't logged, searchable, or transferable. When a student graduates or a faculty member simply moves on from being "new,"

Pain Points & Opportunities

Ranked by severity and strategic leverage

Pain Points

1

No single trustworthy source Stages 2-4

Official channels are incomplete, peer channels are unverified.

2

Rules discovered only after being broken Stages

Real financial / disciplinary cost.

3

Second-impression problem Stages 2-4

Asking again carries social cost, especially for non-freshmen.

4

Knowledge decay at graduation Stage 6

The answer exists briefly in a person, then vanishes.

Opportunities

1

Surface incomplete processes early Stages 2 → 4

Flag known-incomplete-answer processes before the student hits the

2

Proactive rule surfacing Stage 3

Surface unstated rules at the moment they become relevant, not after

3

Structure peer knowledge Stage 4

Give the peer-knowledge channel structure and verification.

4

Capture at the moment of learning Stages → 6

Capture the real answer the instant someone learns it.

Key Insight

The highest-leverage moment is Stage 56: the instant someone learns the real answer is exactly when it should be captured for the next person, instead of relying on them to informally become "the source."

— Break the loop by institutionalizing tacit knowledge at the moment of discovery